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November 20, 2025

Search Committee
Department of Economics
Furman University
Greenville, SC
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the tenure-track (or tenured) position in the Department of Economics at Furman University, beginning August 1, 2026. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

Furman University's Department of Economics is seeking faculty who combine excellence in teaching, student mentoring, and research in a liberal-arts environment. According to the job posting, the department has recently developed a new Finance-Economics major and expects a teaching load of five courses per academic year. I am excited by the opportunity to contribute to this quantitative initiative, teach both core economics and finance-economics courses, and mentor undergraduates in research projects. Furman's vision of expanding access, honoring inquiry, and fostering inclusive excellence strongly resonates with my teaching philosophy and my commitment to mentoring students from diverse backgrounds.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level macro-policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students

“convince themselves” that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At Furman I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, and *Quantitative Methods for Economics*. I would also welcome developing electives such as *Economics of Inequality and Tax Policy* or *Computational Macroeconomics and Policy*, emphasizing reproducible workflows and evidence-based decision-making.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce robust, data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate models that speak to macroeconomic and policy-relevant questions, and (iii) collaborate with faculty and mentor undergraduate students in a liberal-arts setting that values inclusive teaching and high-impact student experiences. I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to join Furman University’s Department of Economics and contribute to its teaching, research, and service missions.

I would be honored to join Furman University’s Department of Economics and to contribute to its teaching and mentoring mission. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with your department at your convenience.

Sincerely,

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